

Audit Preparation Companion

Example Ltd

Building services contractor based in Coventry, West Midlands, delivering mechanical and electrical installations and maintenance for commercial, educational, and NHS buildings across the region.

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Locale	en-GB
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Companion to	Quality Management System Manual · Example Ltd v1.0

This companion guides Example Ltd in preparing for a third-party ISO 9001 audit. It covers the key auditor questions, evidence requirements, and timing expectations for your Quality Management System as currently described, tailored to your actual staff, activities, and records. Use this as your reference for gathering, organising, and checking what an auditor will likely want to see based on your specific processes, people and sector.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 4

Context of the Organisation

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ How does Example Ltd ensure all mechanical and electrical installation activities remain compliant with UK statutory requirements such as CDM regulations and BS 7671, given your focus on commercial, educational, and NHS sites?
- ☐ What specific risks have you identified as most likely to disrupt your ability to deliver to main contractor programme dates? Can you show how these are managed on live jobs?
- ☐ Please describe the boundaries of your Quality Management System. Which activities or locations are excluded, and on what basis?
- ☐ Can you give examples of how context factors such as staff shortages or regulatory updates have led to actual changes in your processes at Example Ltd?

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Copy of the signed, dated Quality Policy statement tailored to the building services sector.
- ☐ Context and scope statement for the QMS, specifying which activities, services and locations are included or excluded (e.g., independent subcontractor works, projects outside West Midlands).
- ☐ Risk assessment records and logs for material delays, compliance lapses, non-completion of paperwork or staff qualification lapses and their mitigation actions.
- ☐ Examples of regulatory compliance evidence: up-to-date CSCS/ECS cards, Gas Safe registration, evidence of compliance to BS 7671 for electrical works.
- ☐ Meeting minutes or communications documenting how changes to regulation, staff resource, or client expectations have led to process updates.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Quality Policy and QMS scope: most recent signed version in use at time of audit; regular annual review recommended.
- ☐ Evidence of how risk identification and process adjustment has been “lived” in recent months, not just in static documents.
- ☐ Regulatory evidence (cards, certifications): must be current and valid at audit. Track expiry dates; do not allow lapses.
- ☐ Document retention (records, cards, risk logs): retained as per applicable UK statutory requirements (see, e.g., 6 years for handover records).

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Review and finalise the Quality Policy statement, ensuring it is signed by Gareth Pryce and available for inspection.
- ☐ Prepare clear documentation of the QMS scope, showing what is and is not included and why.
- ☐ Collect supporting evidence showing risk identification and recent mitigation actions, especially for material delays, programme slippage, and resource shortages.
- ☐ Ensure all qualification, registration and compliance certificates are up to date and accessible for review.
- ☐ Check that risk log entries and evidence of regulatory updates leading to process changes can be demonstrated for at least the previous three months.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 5

Leadership

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ How does Gareth Pryce, as Owner / Managing Director, demonstrate accountability for quality, for example in KPI review meetings or in responding to non-conformances?
- ☐ Can Joanne Clarke and Lee Hammond describe their roles in upholding the Quality Policy and communicating operational requirements to the wider team?
- ☐ How are responsibilities for QMS activities allocated and communicated at Example Ltd, especially in the absence of a separate quality manager?
- ☐ Show how management reviews and process changes are authorised and led by Gareth Pryce.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Recent management meeting minutes or agendas showing review of KPIs: jobs completed to programme, snagging, test pack completion.
- ☐ Logged non-conformance or corrective action records highlighting Gareth's involvement in decisions or escalations.
- ☐ Role descriptions or organigram showing QMS duties for Gareth Pryce, Joanne Clarke, Lee Hammond and Ricky Obeng.
- ☐ Signed-off documentation for any management review that resulted in process updates, new objectives or changes to resource allocation.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Management meetings: evidence from regular reviews (should be at least monthly for KPI and operational monitoring).
- ☐ Management review meeting: at planned intervals — in practice annually, plus ad hoc meetings after significant issues.
- ☐ Role/responsibility documentation: should be current at date of audit and updated after any organisational change.
- ☐ Corrective action logs: keep up to date; older records should be available in line with statutory or contract retention rules.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Ensure the most recent management meeting minutes are collated and available for auditor review.
- ☐ Summarise roles and responsibilities for Gareth, Joanne, Lee and Ricky in a visible format for audit interviews.
- ☐ Collate examples of corrective actions where management leadership was exercised.
- ☐ Have recent process change records ready, especially those with leadership authorisation or sign-off.

ISO 9001 · CHAPTER 6–7

Planning & Support

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ How are Example Ltd's quality objectives (on-time completion, handover with signed test packs, reduced snagging) tracked in practice? Who reviews this and what happens if a metric drifts off target?
- ☐ Can you demonstrate how planning for each new job occurs, including RAMS preparation, supplier selection and material scheduling by Joanne Clarke and Lee Hammond?

- ☐ How is supplier performance monitored and what actions are taken if a merchant or hire company repeatedly fails to deliver as required?
- ☐ What controls ensure only current, approved documentation (forms, RAMS, commissioning packs) are in use? Who checks for superseded documents?
- ☐ Please show how Ricky Obeng tracks the calibration status of test instruments and ensures operatives' CSCS/ECS and Gas Safe registrations remain valid.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Quality Objectives KPI tracking sheet, with monthly updates for: projects delivered to programme, snag item counts, test pack completion rates.
- ☐ Sample job files for recent projects, including pre-start meeting notes, RAMS, materials schedules, and procurement records signed by Joanne Clarke and/or Lee Hammond.
- ☐ Supplier review records — informal reviews with comments on reliability and quality, showing actions where suppliers were changed due to persistent issues.
- ☐ Examples of controlled document registers maintained by Joanne, and any logs of superseded documents and active file directory audits.
- ☐ Calibration records and renewal reminders for plant/test equipment (managed by Ricky Obeng), plus records of qualification expiry dates and proof of current CSCS/ECS or Gas Safe registration.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ KPI tracking: update monthly, minimum three months' live data prior to Stage 2 audit; objectives reviewed at management reviews (typically annual).
- ☐ Job documentation: retain all project files for at least six years post-handover or longer if required by contract or statutory requirement.
- ☐ Supplier reviews: conduct at least annually or when performance issues arise.
- ☐ Calibration of test equipment: annually, with records available for current and previous cycles.
- ☐ CSCS/ECS and Gas Safe certificates: must always be current and monitored for renewal well in advance of expiry.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Start recording monthly KPI updates for all three main quality objectives.
- ☐ File job documentation (RAMS, procurement, delivery records, handover packs) to demonstrate controlled document use and approval.
- ☐ Collate supplier review notes, making sure any actions (e.g. supplier changes) are documented.
- ☐ Confirm calibration and qualification tracking registers are complete, current and easily accessible.

- ☐ Schedule a pre-audit check of file folders to ensure only valid, controlled documents are in use and archived/superseded files are segregated.

Operation, Performance Evaluation & Improvement

AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Show a real job file (e.g., a school or NHS project) where the process was followed from contract award through to handover, including programme tracking, snagging, test pack completion, and signed documentation.
- ☐ Please provide records from a recent internal audit showing what process was sampled and how findings were addressed.
- ☐ What is the process for identifying, logging, and closing out corrective actions when issues arise (such as incomplete paperwork or late deliveries)? Can you show evidence of closure and follow-up?
- ☐ How is customer feedback (from main contractors or public sector clients) handled, and how are lessons learned captured and acted upon?
- ☐ Please show a management review outcome that led to an improvement or change in documented procedure within Example Ltd.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Full job files from at least one live contract: including dated programme, RAMS, signed-off stage inspections, signed test certificates and handover documentation, snag list reports.
- ☐ Internal audit schedule and at least one completed internal audit report (showing sampling of processes such as planning, procurement, installation, handover, or corrective action handling).
- ☐ Corrective action log with issue report, investigation, assignment, implementation of fixes and evidence of closure; examples where process change resulted from recurring issues.
- ☐ Copies of customer feedback forms, client emails, and management review action lists related to lessons learned, improvements, or repeat non-conformances.
- ☐ Signed minutes from management review meetings, showing decisions on improvements or changes in documented process.

TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Internal audits: at least annually, covering all QMS core processes over a set cycle; must have happened before Stage 2.
- ☐ Corrective actions: log updates as issues occur; recent (within the last 3 months) examples must be ready for audit.
- ☐ Handover/job files: latest live projects must have up-to-date, signed documentation; old records retained for at least 6 years (UK practice) unless contractually specified otherwise.
- ☐ Management review: conducted at planned intervals (normally annual), but action items and minutes should always be available from the most recent review.

PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Carry out at least one complete internal audit covering a core process; record findings and corrective actions.
- ☐ Review and file full end-to-end job records for a recent project, from tender/contract award to signed handover documentation.
- ☐ Ensure a complete, current corrective action log is available, with examples showing closure of issues and process updates.
- ☐ Gather key management review evidence — signed minutes, action trackers — and highlight at least one change/improvement implemented as a result.
- ☐ Consolidate evidence of customer feedback loops (e.g., emails from main contractors, lessons learned summaries) to show responsiveness and improvement.